

DESCRIBE. TEST. RESPOND.

A practical guide to a constructive conversation

SINGLE-EVENT
WORKSHEET

DATE
Relevant date

EVENT OR PROCESS

Name the specific matter you are preparing to discuss

1	DESCRIBE Establish the event, expectation, and effect			2	TEST Check comparison, explanations, and missing information		
1	What happened? Record the specific event or process, relevant dates, and sequence. Focus on observable or verifiable details.			4	What is the closest fair comparison? State why it is comparable and which relevant differences might matter.		
2	What rule or expectation applied? Was it written, stated, customary, or inferred? Where did it come from?			5	What ordinary explanations should be checked? Identify possible explanations and the information needed to test them.		
3	What practical consequence followed? Note a concrete effect on work, access, time, a decision, credit, responsibility, or risk.			6	What do I know, assume, and still need to ask? Make clear what is confirmed, inferred, or unknown.		
				KNOW Verifiable facts	ASSUME My interpretation	NEED TO ASK Missing information	
3 RESPOND Choose a proportionate correction and next step							
7	What is the smallest useful correction? Choose a proportionate action that addresses the issue.						
8	What will I ask, of whom, and by when? State the request, the right person or role, timing, confirmation method, and review route if unresolved.						
REQUEST What I will ask							
PERSON / ROLE Who can answer or act				BY Date or decision point			
CONFIRM ANSWER BY Email, note, decision record...				IF UNRESOLVED Appropriate review route			
CONVERSATION STARTER I expected _____ because _____. What happened was _____, with the practical effect _____. Could we clarify or correct _____?							